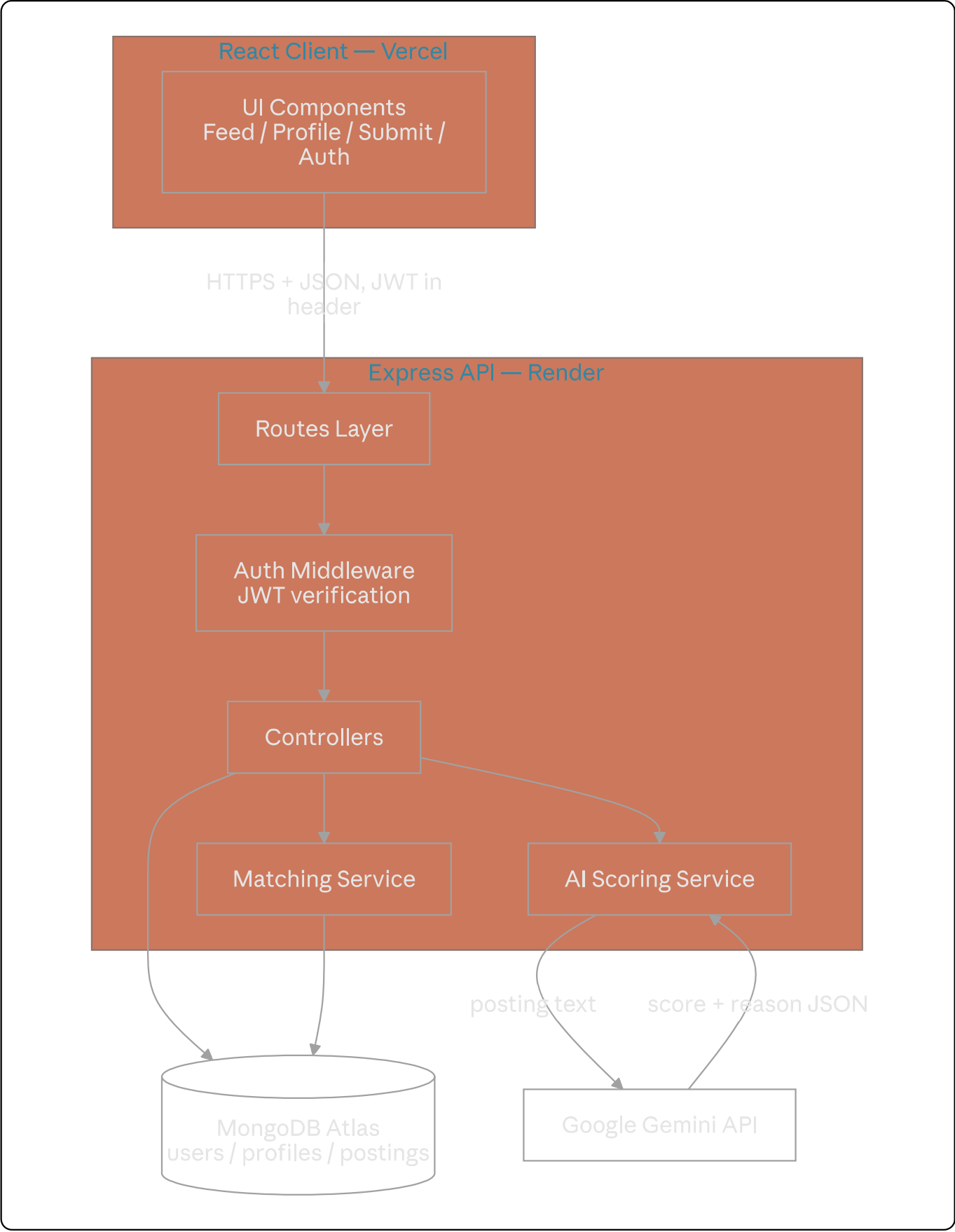


ARCHITECTURE.md — InternTrust

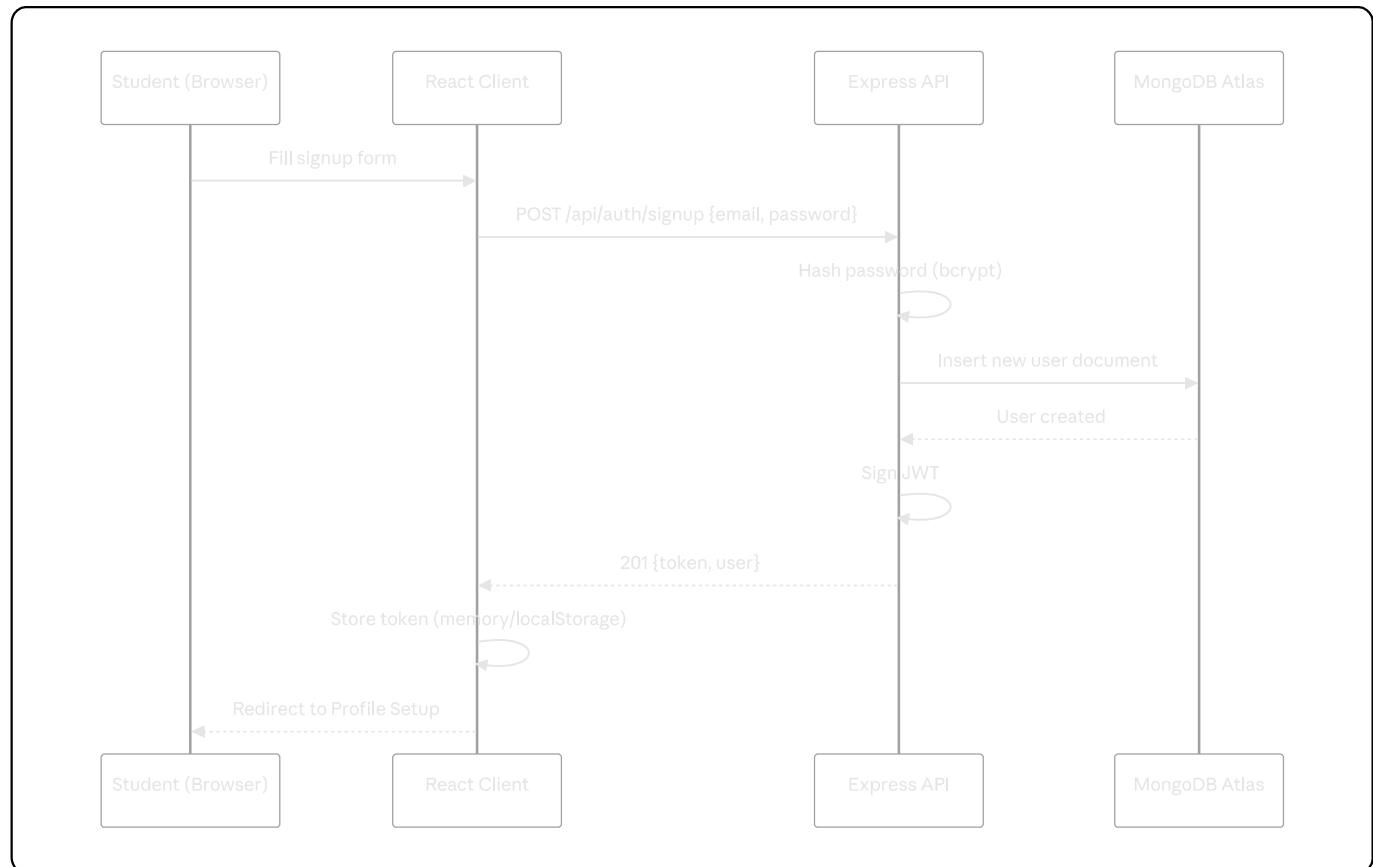
Tech Stack (Locked Day 2)

Layer	Choice	Why
Frontend	React (Vite)	Fast dev server, minimal config, prior React experience
Backend	Node.js + Express	One language end-to-end, proves real full-stack ownership
Database	MongoDB Atlas (free tier)	Flexible schema for skill arrays, free forever tier
Auth	Custom JWT (Express + bcrypt + jsonwebtoken)	Free, no vendor lock-in, demonstrates real auth implementation
AI	Google Gemini API (free tier)	Genuine free tier, supports structured JSON output
Hosting	Vercel (frontend) + Render (backend)	Both free, auto-deploy from GitHub
Other libs	mongoose, cors, dotenv, axios, react-router-dom	Standard, free, well-documented

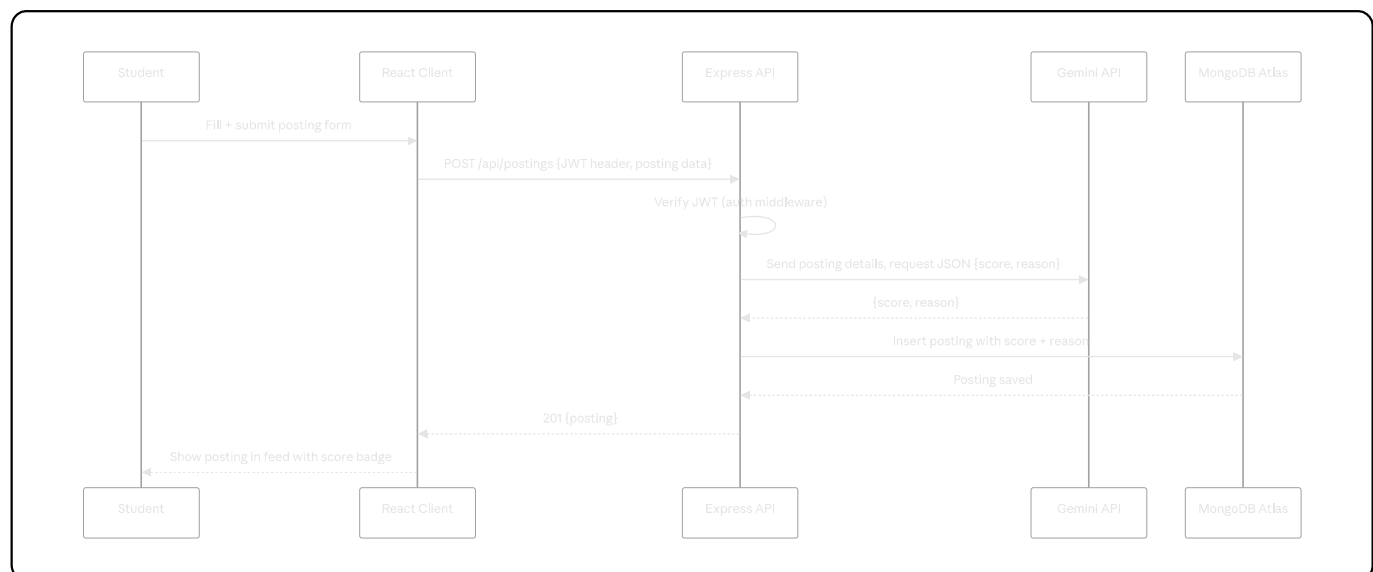
Component Diagram



Data Flow — Signup & Login

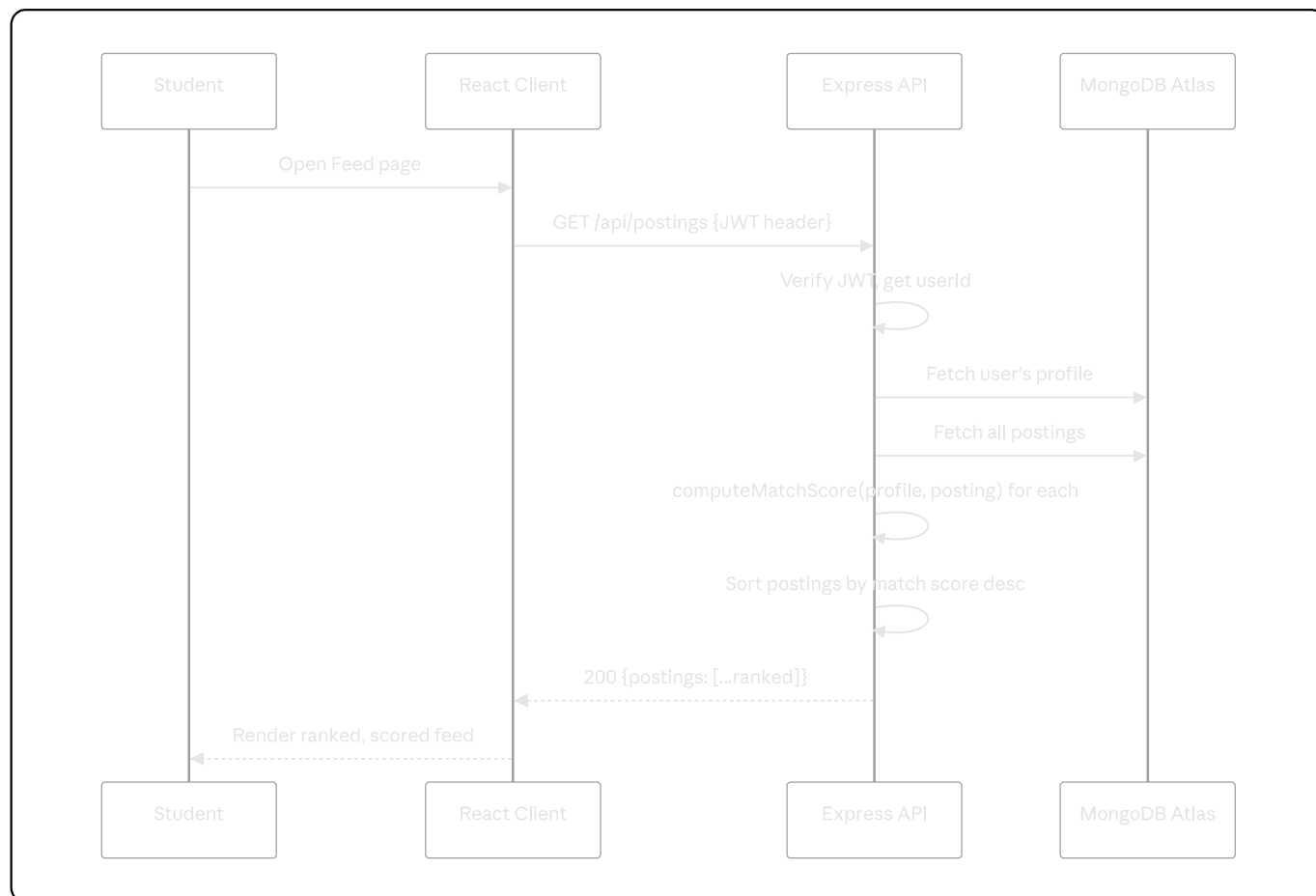


Data Flow — Submit Posting (with AI Scoring)



Implementation decision (locked Day 2): scoring runs **synchronously** on submit (call AI, wait for response, then save). Simpler to build and test than an async/pending-then-update flow, and demo-scale posting volume won't expose performance issues.

Data Flow — Fetch Ranked Feed



External Services

- **MongoDB Atlas** — persistent storage (free tier, 512MB)
- **Google Gemini API** — legitimacy scoring (free tier)
- **Render** — backend hosting (free web service, auto-deploy from GitHub)
- **Vercel** — frontend hosting (free, auto-deploy from GitHub)